

The Gaokao Factory

AIGC Video Series | 2026

The Gaokao Factory is a series of short AI-generated videos that explores the collective experience of academic competition through surreal yet familiar visual metaphors.

Rather than depicting classrooms, exams, or school life directly, the project reimagines the high-stakes educational journey as a collection of industrial systems, consumer products, and automated infrastructures. Students appear as capsules inside a vending machine, runners trapped in giant hamster wheels, or products moving through a packaging line. These environments are not fantastical worlds but recognizable systems that quietly shape behavior, sort individuals, and assign value.

The project investigates the tension between effort, chance, and institutional control. How much of success is determined by persistence? How much is influenced by systems beyond individual agency? Through dreamlike but believable scenarios, the videos transform abstract social structures into tangible visual experiences.

Generated through AI-assisted image and video workflows, the project uses AIGC not only as a production tool but as a medium for rapidly constructing symbolic worlds. By combining generative imagery with conceptual storytelling, the work explores new possibilities for visualizing collective experiences and social narratives.

Capsule Machine

Thousands of students are sealed inside individual transparent capsules, each carrying books, notes, and unfinished assignments. As the capsules tumble inside a giant vending machine, every student continues studying, sleeping, or working without interruption.

The machine becomes a metaphor for uncertainty within a highly competitive system. While effort remains constant, outcomes appear increasingly shaped by forces beyond individual control. The work reflects the uneasy relationship between hard work, chance, and selection.

Hamster Wheel

Inside a vast school gymnasium, countless students run alone within giant hamster wheels. Some sprint desperately, some struggle to keep pace, and others appear exhausted, yet every wheel continues turning.

The piece visualizes the experience of continuous competition and self-discipline. Although everyone is moving forward, each wheel operates at a different speed, suggesting unequal conditions hidden beneath the appearance of a shared race.

Packaging Line

Students are vacuum-sealed alongside textbooks and study materials, moving slowly through a pristine automated packaging facility. Conveyor belts guide them toward a massive industrial mixing drum where thousands of packaged students accumulate and rotate together.

Borrowing the visual language of logistics and manufacturing, the video imagines education as a process of standardization, classification, and mass production. Individual identities remain visible, yet increasingly become part of a larger system designed to organize, evaluate, and process human potential.